

# Ancient Scripts — Annotated Samples

*Concise, educational demonstrations of original text, transliteration and translation.*

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These samples show how Scriptorium presents historical-language work: each entry gives the original in its own script, a transliteration, a literal and a polished translation into English and Spanish, and a short philological note. They are offered as study and annotation, not as critical academic editions or certified translations.

## Latin — Roman script

Verba volant, scripta manent.

**Transliteration:** *verba volant, scripta manent*

**Literal:** words fly, written things remain

**English:** Spoken words fly away; written words remain.

**Español:** Las palabras habladas vuelan; lo escrito permanece.

**Note:** A classical proverb on the durability of writing — a fitting motto for any scriptorium.

## Ancient Greek — Greek script

γνῶθι σεαυτόν

**Transliteration:** *gnōthi seautón*

**Literal:** know yourself

**English:** Know yourself.

**Español:** Conócete a ti mismo.

**Note:** A Delphic maxim inscribed at the Temple of Apollo at Delphi; widely cited in Greek philosophy.

## Biblical Hebrew — Hebrew script (read right to left)

בְּרֵאשִׁית

**Transliteration:** *bərē'šīt*

**Literal:** in (the) beginning of

**English:** In the beginning.

**Español:** En el principio.

**Note:** The first word of Genesis 1:1. The vowel points (niqqud) guide pronunciation; the script reads right to left.

## Classical Arabic — Arabic script (read right to left)

الْعِلْمُ نُورٌ

**Transliteration:** *al-ʿilmu nūr*

**Literal:** the-knowledge (is) light

**English:** Knowledge is light.

**Español:** El conocimiento es luz.

**Note:** A well-known Arabic proverb. Arabic is cursive and read right to left; short vowels are shown here as diacritics for clarity.

## Sanskrit — Devanāgarī script

सत्यमेव जयते

**Transliteration:** *satyam-eva jayate*

**Literal:** truth-alone triumphs

**English:** Truth alone triumphs.

**Español:** Solo la verdad triunfa.

**Note:** From the Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad (3.1.6); adopted as the national motto of India. IAST transliteration.

## Old Norse — Elder Futhark runes

𐍂𐍋𐍃𐍂

**Transliteration:** *f-r-i-þ-r* (*friðr*)

**Literal:** peace

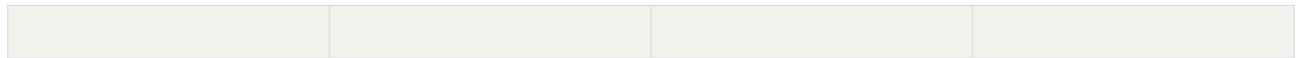
**English:** Peace.

**Español:** Paz.

**Note:** The Old Norse word *friðr* written in Elder Futhark. Runic spelling of later Old Norse is a reconstruction for teaching; historical inscriptions vary.

## Reference: the first six Elder Futhark runes

| Rune | Name     | Sound  | Meaning                 |
|------|----------|--------|-------------------------|
| 𐍆    | fehu     | f      | cattle, wealth          |
| 𐍘    | uruz     | u      | aurochs, strength       |
| 𐍄    | thurisaz | th (þ) | giant, thorn            |
| 𐍅    | ansuz    | a      | god (Æsir), inspiration |
| 𐍇    | raido    | r      | riding, journey         |
| 𐍈    | kaunan   | k      | torch, knowledge        |



*The alphabet is named after the sounds of its first six runes: f-u-p-a-r-k → "Futhark."*

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